

NAME

ipc – System V IPC system calls

LIBRARY

Standard C library (*libc*, *-lc*)

SYNOPSIS

```
#include <linux/ipc.h>    /* Definition of needed constants */
#include <sys/syscall.h>    /* Definition of SYS_* constants */
#include <unistd.h>

int syscall(SYS_ipc, unsigned int call, int first,
            unsigned long second, unsigned long third, void *ptr,
            long fifth);
```

Note: glibc provides no wrapper for **ipc()**, necessitating the use of **syscall(2)**.

DESCRIPTION

ipc() is a common kernel entry point for the System V IPC calls for messages, semaphores, and shared memory. *call* determines which IPC function to invoke; the other arguments are passed through to the appropriate call.

User-space programs should call the appropriate functions by their usual names. Only standard library implementors and kernel hackers need to know about **ipc()**.

VERSIONS

On some architectures—for example x86-64 and ARM—there is no **ipc()** system call; instead, **msgctl(2)**, **semctl(2)**, **shmctl(2)**, and so on really are implemented as separate system calls.

STANDARDS

Linux.

SEE ALSO

msgctl(2), **msgget(2)**, **msgrcv(2)**, **msgsnd(2)**, **semctl(2)**, **semget(2)**, **semop(2)**, **semtimedop(2)**, **shmat(2)**, **shmctl(2)**, **shmdt(2)**, **shmget(2)**, **sysvipc(7)**